

ENG509 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

ENG509 Morphology and Syntax

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Lesson 01

What is Morphology?

Topic 01: Introduction

What does morphology study?

Morphology studies form or forms, specifically in linguistics, it refers to the internal structure of words.

What are the goals of morphological analysis?

The goals of morphological analysis include understanding how words are formed and their grammatical properties.

What is the place of morphology in the general theory of grammar?

Morphology is a distinct component of languages or grammars within the broader field of linguistics.

What is the origin of the term "morphology"?

The term "morphology" has its roots in the Greek word "morph," meaning 'shape' or 'form.'

Topic 02: Morpheme

What is a morpheme?

A morpheme is the smallest linguistic unit with a grammatical function, and it can be a whole word or a meaningful part of a word.

How can morphemes be defined in terms of sound and meaning?

Morphemes can be defined as pairings between sound and meaning, which may not always have a concrete or continuous form.

What is the difference between a stem and a root in morphology?

A stem is a base unit to which other morphological pieces are attached, while a root is a morphologically simple unit that constitutes the core of a word.

Topic 03: Morphology in Action

Give examples of novel words and word play.

Novel words and word play involve creating new words or variations using existing word pieces, such as "unbreak" and "uncry."

Topic 04: Abstract Morphological Facts

What is an example of a language with no morphological plural?

Indonesian and Japanese are examples of languages with no morphological plural forms.

Provide an example illustrating English morphological distinctions.

English distinguishes between "tell" and "told," where the past tense is not formed by adding "-t," "-d," or "-ed."

Topic 05: Background & Beliefs

How do linguists differentiate between languages and Language?

Linguists differentiate between individual languages (small-l language) and Language in general (capital-L Language).

What foundational belief do linguists hold about morphology?

Linguists believe that morphology is a distinct component of languages or grammars.

What methodological attitude do linguists adopt, according to the lesson?

Linguists adopt an attitude of skeptical realism and a "anything goes" approach to linguistics, not being tied to specific theories.

Lesson 02

Words and Lexemes

Topic: 06: Intro to Morphological Analysis

What are the two basic approaches in morphological analysis?

The two basic approaches in morphological analysis are analysis and synthesis.

What is Principle 1 in morphological analysis?

Principle 1 states that forms with the same meaning and the same sound shape in all their occurrences are instances of the same morpheme.

Explain Principle 3 in morphological analysis.

Principle 3 states that not all morphemes are segmental, meaning some morphemes may not be composed of individual segments or sounds.

What is the significance of Principle 4 in morphological analysis?

Principle 4 states that a morpheme may have zero as one of its allomorphs provided it has a non-zero allomorph, emphasizing the variation in how morphemes can be realized.

Can you explain Principle 1 in morphological analysis?

Principle 1 in morphological analysis states that forms with the same meaning and the same sound shape in all their occurrences are instances of the same morpheme. In other words, if two forms have identical meanings and sound the same whenever they appear, they can be considered as manifestations of a single morpheme.

What is Principle 4 in morphological analysis, and why is it significant?

Answer 3: Principle 4 in morphological analysis states that a morpheme may have zero as one of its allomorphs provided it has a non-zero allomorph. This principle is significant because it acknowledges that morphemes can have variations, including a zero realization, depending on the context. It helps us understand the flexibility and complexity of morphological analysis.

Topic: 07: What is a Word

How do linguists define a word?

Various ways to define a word exist, but there is no entirely satisfactory definition.

What is the significance of lexical categories like noun, verb, adjective, and adverb?

Lexical categories tell us how a word is generally used in a sentence. For example, a noun can be the subject of a sentence, while a verb cannot.

Give an example of a sentence where identical-sounding words belong to multiple categories.

"MINERS REFUSE TO WORK AFTER DEATH" is an example where identical-sounding words belong to multiple categories. "REFUSE" can be both a noun and a verb.

Explain the significance of lexical categories like noun, verb, adjective, and adverb.

Lexical categories, such as noun, verb, adjective, and adverb, are labels used by linguists to describe how a word is generally used in a sentence. For example, a noun typically functions as the subject of a sentence, while a verb indicates an action. These categories help linguists analyze sentence structure and understand the roles different words play in communication.

Topic: 08: Types of Words

What is the difference between content words and function words?

Content words (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs) carry meaning, while function words (pronouns, prepositions, etc.) serve grammatical purposes.

Question 2: What are lexemes?

Lexemes are theoretical constructs that correspond to different senses of a word. They help distinguish among forms with similar sounds but different meanings.

What are lexemes, and how do they help distinguish word meanings?

Lexemes are theoretical constructs that correspond to different senses of a word. They help distinguish among forms with similar sounds but different meanings.

For example, multiple senses of the word "bank" can be distinguished as separate lexemes, such as a financial institution (bank1) and the side of a river (bank2).

Topic: 09: Empirical Tests for Wordhood

What empirical tests can determine whether something is a word?

Empirical tests for wordhood include fixed order of elements, non-separability, integrity, and stress patterns.

How does changing the order of morphemes in a word affect its grammaticality?

Changing the order of morphemes in a word often results in something ungrammatical, illustrating the importance of word order.

Why is changing the order of morphemes in a word often ungrammatical in English, and how does this relate to wordhood?

Changing the order of morphemes in a word is often ungrammatical in English because word order is crucial for conveying meaning. In English, sentences have a specific word order, and altering it can result in a loss of grammaticality. This demonstrates the importance of word order in defining what constitutes a word in a language.

Topic: 10: Inflection Vs. Derivation

What does inflection involve?

Inflection involves forming grammatical forms of a single lexeme, such as past tense, plural, etc.

How does derivation differ from inflection?

Derivation creates one lexeme from another and typically involves changes in lexical meaning or category, whereas inflection does not.

Provide examples of words with inflectional morphemes and derivational affixes, and explain their significance.

Words with inflectional morphemes include nouns like "wombat + s" (plural form) and verbs like "dig + s" (third person singular). Derivational affixes create new words, like "un + tie" (to untie), and change categories, as in "gray + ish" (grayish adjective). Understanding these distinctions is essential for analyzing word formation in a language.

Topic: 11: Two Approaches to Morphology

What are the two approaches to morphology proposed by Hockett?

Hockett proposed the Item-and-Arrangement (I&A) and Item-and-Process (I&P) approaches to morphology.

How do I&A and I&P models relate to each other?

I&A and I&P models are mathematically almost equivalent, with everything expressible in one model being expressible in the other.

Topic: 12: The Lexicon

What is the lexicon in linguistics?

The lexicon refers to the mental dictionary of a language, containing words, irregular forms, and their meanings.

What makes the lexicon different from a list of morphemes?

The lexicon includes irregular and unpredictable forms, not just indivisible morphemes, making it more comprehensive and reflective of linguistic memory.

Lesson 03

Morphology and Phonology I

Topic: 13: Morphology and Phonology

What are some interactions between morphology and phonology?

Some interactions between morphology and phonology are known as morphophonology or morphophonemics, involving processes like assimilation.

What is the significance of studying the phonological processes in morphology?

Studying phonological processes in morphology helps understand how they affect the shapes of morphemes.

What are the two general types of affixes mentioned in this lesson?

The two general types of affixes discussed are primary and secondary affixes.

How do secret languages use morphology and phonology to disguise word shapes?

Secret languages use regular phonological rules to alter word shapes, making them less recognizable.

What are the two general types of affixes mentioned in this lesson, and how are they distinguished?

The two general types of affixes are distinguished, in part, by phonological criteria. They are primary and secondary affixes. Primary affixes often have Latin-Romance origins, while secondary affixes are frequently of native Germanic origin. These distinctions provide insights into the historical development of morphemes in English.

Topic: 14: Allomorphs

What are allomorphs in linguistics?

Allomorphs are different phonological forms of a morpheme, with each form used in specific linguistic contexts.

In English, what are some examples of the plural marker allomorphs?

In English, plural markers include [s], [z], [ə z], [ɪ], and null.

How is the distribution of allomorphs of the English past tense suffix explained?

The distribution of allomorphs of the English past tense suffix can be explained by phonological rules. The basic form is /d/, but when [t] appears, it has assimilated to the preceding segment in voicing. Additionally, [ə] is added by an automatic phonological rule of epenthesis, triggered by agreement in place and continuancy between the final segment in the verb and the suffix itself.

Topic: 15: Prosodic Morphology

What is prosodic morphology concerned with?

Prosodic morphology deals with the interaction of morphology and prosodic structures, such as syllables, vowels, and timing units.

What are some examples of phonotactic constraints in languages?

Phonotactic constraints can involve restrictions on consonant combinations and syllable structures in languages.

What are some examples of phenomena within prosodic morphology?

Prosodic morphology encompasses phenomena such as phonotactic constraints (restrictions on phoneme combinations), root-and-pattern morphology (where roots consist of consonants with added vowels), and reduplication (repeating parts of a word). These aspects are vital in understanding how morphology interacts with prosody.

Topic: 16: Primary and Secondary Affixes

What is the primary-secondary affix distinction in English morphology based on?

The primary-secondary affix distinction in English is based on the etymological origin of the affixes, with primary affixes often being of Latin-Romance origin and secondary affixes of Germanic origin.

How does stress placement differ between primary and secondary affixes?

Primary affixes cause a stress shift, while secondary affixes do not.

What is the primary–secondary affix distinction, and how is it related to language history?

The primary–secondary affix distinction categorizes affixes into primary (often of Latin-Romance origin) and secondary (usually of native Germanic origin) affixes.

This distinction is closely linked to the historical development of language.

Primary affixes cause stress shifts, while secondary affixes do not.

Topic: 17: Linguistic Exaptation, Leveling, and Analogy

What is linguistic exaptation?

Linguistic exaptation is the process by which linguistic elements with lost meanings or functions are repurposed in language evolution.

What role does leveling and analogy play in language change?

Leveling and analogy are powerful forces in language change, driven by the preference for phonological and morphological similarity among words.

How do leveling and analogy impact the development of languages over time?

Leveling and analogy are powerful linguistic forces that drive language development. Speakers tend to prefer regular paradigms over irregular ones, leading to the elimination of sound alternations that do not signal important differences in meaning. These processes result in more consistent and systematic language structures over time.

Topic: 18: Morphophonology and Secret Languages

What are secret languages, and how do they relate to phonology and morphology?

Secret languages are constructed languages that manipulate phonological and morphological rules to disguise word shapes.

What is the key distinction between Pig Latin and Verlan?

Pig Latin shifts the initial sound of a word to the end and adds a suffix, while Verlan reverses the syllables of words.

Why are secret languages considered somewhat artificial in linguistic analysis?

Secret languages, like Pig Latin and Verlan, involve artificial rules that operate on letters rather than phonological entities, making them less suitable for drawing conclusions about natural languages.

What are secret languages, and why do they exist in various cultures?

Secret languages are linguistic codes used to hide the meaning of words from outsiders. They exist in various cultures as a means of communication among specific groups or communities. Secret languages can serve as a form of exclusion or identity within a community.

Lesson 04

Derivation and the Lexicon

Topic 19: The Saussurean Sign

Who is Ferdinand de Saussure, and what did he believe about language?

Ferdinand de Saussure was a linguist who believed that language is a system of signs. He defined a linguistic sign as a pairing between a signifier (a sequence of sounds) and a signified (the concept it represents).

What is the difference between motivated and unmotivated signs?

Motivated signs provide clues about their meaning, while unmotivated signs do not. For example, a walk signal is motivated because it shows a person walking, indicating whether to cross the street.

Topic 20: Motivation and Compositionality

What is compositionality, and how is it related to motivation?

Compositionality means something can be defined in terms of its parts. Motivation is related because motivated signs are partially or fully compositional, allowing you to deduce meaning from their components.

Give examples of English words that are partially motivated and compositional.

Words like "behead," "befriend," "besiege," and "bewitch" are partially motivated and compositional.

Topic 21: Zero-derivation

What is zero-derivation, and how does it change the lexical category of a word?

Zero-derivation is a process where a word's lexical category changes without any change in its phonological form. It creates a new word class from an existing one.

Provide examples of novel verbs formed by zero-derivation.

Examples include "Don't hair me," "Rocker me, mommy," and "I broomed her."

Topic 22: Other Derivational Processes

What is blending, and how does it differ from affixation?

Blending is a word formation process that combines parts of two or more words to create a new one. It differs from affixation because it doesn't adhere to strict constraints.

Explain what acronyms are and give examples.

Acronyms are formed from initial letters of words to create a new word. Examples include "NATO" and "FBI."

Topic 23: Clipping & Backformation

What is clipping, and how is it used to create new words?

Clipping is the creation of new words by truncating existing ones. It's often used to form nicknames or shorter versions of words.

What is folk etymology, and can you provide examples?

Folk etymology occurs when speakers reinterpret a word based on existing words or morphemes. Examples include "cockroach" from Spanish "cucaracha" and "witch hazel" from "wych hazel."

What is backformation, and how does it create new words?

Backformation is the creation of a word by removing what appears to be an affix. It often involves reanalyzing a word's structure.

Topic 24: Derivation and Structure

How can we schematize derivation?

Derivation can be schematized as a process where one lexeme serves as the input for another, forming a chain of derivational functions.

What are the roles of prefixes like "un-" in English, and how can they lead to ambiguity?

Prefix "un-" can serve as a reversative (undoing an action) when attached to verbs and as a negation (meaning "not") when attached to adjectives, potentially causing ambiguity.

Lesson 05

Words & its Forms: Inflections

Topic: 25 - Words and Grammar

What are lexemes?

Lexemes are abstract words that represent grammatically conditioned variants of a more basic word.

How do we refer to lexemes in English?

Lexemes are referred to by their bare, unaffixed forms.

Can the same word form belong to different lexemes?

Yes, the same word form can belong to different lexemes in English.

What are some examples of grammatically conditioned variants of words, and why do they not always need to be listed in a dictionary?

Grammatically conditioned variants of words are words that have predictable meanings and are not always listed in dictionaries. These variants illustrate that a

word can be a grammatically conditioned variant of a more basic word, which may or may not be listed in the dictionary based on its predictability. For example, "performs," "performed," and "perform" are all inflectional variants of the lexeme "perform." The term "lexeme" is introduced to represent the more abstract kind of word, and it's important to note that a lexeme itself is not something that can be pronounced; only its word forms can be uttered.

Topic: 26 - Regular and Irregular Inflection

Why don't words like "pianists" and "pianist" need to be listed separately in a dictionary?

They are grammatically conditioned variants of one basic word (lexeme), so they are not listed separately.

What are the two reasons for not listing some words in dictionaries?

The first reason is that nouns denoting countable things often have predictable plural forms. The second reason is that adding "-s" is the regular method of forming plurals.

Can you give examples of irregular plurals in English?

Examples of irregular plurals include "children," "teeth," "men," and "women."

Why are words like "pianists" and "pianist" not listed separately in dictionaries, and what are the reasons for this?

Words like "pianists" and "pianist" are not listed separately in dictionaries because they are grammatically conditioned variants of a single basic word or lexeme, "pianist." There are two main reasons for this. Firstly, nouns denoting countable

entities like "pianist" have predictable plural forms without idiosyncratic meaning changes, usually formed by adding the suffix "-s." Secondly, the regular method for forming plurals in English involves adding "-s," making it unnecessary to list all these variants separately.

Topic: 27 - Forms of Nouns

How do we determine whether a noun in English is singular or plural?

The distinction between singular and plural nouns is determined by the syntactic context.

Do all nouns referring to countable entities have both singular and plural forms?

No, some nouns like "scissors" and "pants" exist only in plural forms.

Question 4: How do countable nouns in English typically express their singular and plural forms?

Countable nouns in English typically have two word forms: a singular and a plural form. The plural form is usually created by adding the suffix "-s" to the singular form, denoting "more than one" of the noun. For example, "cat" becomes "cats" in the plural form.

Topic: 28 - Forms of Pronouns and Determiners

What is the singular and plural form of the determiner "this"?

Answer: The singular form is "this," and the plural form is "these."

How do pronouns differ from nouns in terms of inflection?

Pronouns have a small set of inflected forms, such as "he" and "him," which exhibit case distinctions.

What is the role of determiners in English, and how do they exhibit singular-plural contrast?

Determiners in English play a role similar to nouns and pronouns, but they often exhibit a singular-plural contrast. For example, "this" and "these" are the singular and plural forms of the determiner lexeme "this." Another example is "that," with singular and plural forms "that" and "those." These determiners demonstrate that number contrasts can affect noun phrases, not just subject noun phrases and verbs.

Topic: 29 - Forms of Verbs

How many distinct forms can a verb lexeme have in English?

A verb lexeme in English can have up to five distinct forms.

What is the primary distinction between the forms of English verbs?

The primary distinction is tense, with additional contrasts in person and number.

How many forms can a verb lexeme have in English, and what are some examples of these forms?

A verb lexeme in English can have at most five distinct forms. For instance, the verb "give" has the following forms:

- a. third person singular present tense: "gives"
- b. past tense: "gave"
- c. progressive participle: "giving"
- d. perfect or passive participle: "given"

e. basic form: "give"

These forms represent different tenses and aspects of the verb, but not all verbs have all five forms. Most verbs have only four forms because the past tense and the perfect (or passive) participle forms are the same.

Topic: 30 - Forms of Adjectives

What are the three forms that many English adjectives exhibit?

Many adjectives have positive, comparative, and superlative forms.

What do the suffixes "-er" and "-est" signify in adjectives?

They signify the comparative and superlative degrees of adjectives, respectively.

When do adjectives typically require periphrastic forms for comparison?

Longer adjectives usually require periphrastic forms for comparison, while shorter ones can use "-er" and "-est."

How do adjectives in English typically form their comparative and superlative forms, and why do some adjectives not follow this pattern?

Many English adjectives form their comparative and superlative forms by adding the suffixes "-er" and "-est." For example, "green" becomes "greener" and "greenest." However, some adjectives exhibit irregular forms, like "better" and "best," which are suppletive. The choice between regular and irregular forms often depends on whether the adjective's basic form has one syllable or two, with the second syllable ending in a vowel. Longer adjectives usually require periphrastic forms, such as "more" or "most" before the adjective. The presence or absence of

comparative and superlative forms is not uniform across all adjectives and depends on their specific characteristics.

Working on the Next Lessons

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